THE SI SENTINEL

Weekday briefing on builders shaping super intelligence

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 15, 2026

THE WEDNESDAY PICTURE

Shopping agents hit Amazon's wall, and a $1 million sandbox gives up a kernel bug

Amazon kept turning away AI agents that shop for their owners, and Elon Musk told Grok Bot users to take their business elsewhere, promising that SpaceX would cover any purchase mistake. Aaron Levie argued that agents working in the background will use 100 to 1,000 times more computing than chat does today. Vercel reported what a $1 million escape challenge turned up: 1,285 reports in two weeks and one Linux kernel flaw that cuts across nearly every cloud sandbox.

Alexandr Wang kept promoting Meta's Muse Wonder, SpaceXAI's Grok Voice 3.0 took first place on a speech benchmark, and Noam Brown pointed to an OpenAI model that corrected a physics test's answer key. François Chollet said intelligence needs "contact with reality." Musk posted 50 times, on Grok Bot, Starlink in Ukraine and tonight's Roadster demo. Seventeen of the 45 builders posted.

I · AGENTS GO SHOPPING

Amazon says no, Musk says shop elsewhere

Amazon is blocking AI agents that buy on its site without permission. The watch list sees an opening for stores built for software buyers.

13.9M	100–1,000×	34.7M
Views by Thursday morning on Musk's 1:24am EDT post telling Grok Bot users to buy elsewhere	Aaron Levie's estimate of the jump in token use when agents work in the background	Views on Musk's "Grok @Bot rocks" quote of a user review

Elon Musk @elonmusk · CEO, SpaceX and Tesla

Farzad (@farzyness) posted a screenshot on Wednesday afternoon of Amazon refusing him: "Dear Amazon, I am not an agent. Why are you blocking me from shopping on your website?" At 9:22pm EDT Musk replied:

> *"Just ask Grok Bot to find the best deal on the Internet for what you want. Doesn't need to come from Amazon. My Bot bought LEGO directly from the LEGO website no problem."*
>
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST

A few hours later Nic Cruz Patane shared the message his own bots now get from Amazon: "Continued access by an unauthorized AI agent violates Amazon's Conditions of Use, to which our customers have agreed." Musk quoted it at 1:24am EDT: "Just ask Grok @Bot to buy what you want someplace else and get a better deal. There are far more purchasing websites than just Amazon!"

The same pop-up greeted users of Meta's Muse agent, GeekWire reported. Amazon says Meta never told it Muse would visit the store, that the agent does not identify itself while browsing, and that it appears to capture and store customer credentials. Amazon has spent the past year keeping outside agents off its site, including suing Perplexity over its Comet browser. Its own Buy for Me agent, the company points out, identifies itself and lets brands opt out. Shoppers reported Amazon blocking Grok bots on the Whole Foods site as early as October 3.

Musk also took on the main worry about letting a bot pay. When a user said Grok Bot had booked a flight from a photo of a credit card, he wrote:

> *"This works well. If Grok @Bot makes a mistake with a purchase or leaks your card (never happened yet), SpaceX will make you whole."*
>
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST

A user asked for the bot to save web passwords because "it keeps making me log in." Musk: "Coming very soon." The commentator Joe Hansen wrote that Amazon's blocks "just open the door for stores built for bots. Clean product data, real prices and a checkout a machine can use." Musk: "Yup."

Musk shared other uses. One user said a bot spotted a phishing link hidden in an email from an x.ai address that had passed every standard sender check, and Musk wrote "Grok @Bot can detect scam emails." His quote of the YouTuber NetworkChuck ("I was wrong about @bot... I connected my email, calendar and custom apps, and it just works") passed 34 million views: "Grok @Bot rocks."

Aaron Levie @levie · CEO, Box

At 2:45am EDT, Levie posted an essay on where agent use is going:

> *"Moving from chatting back and forth with agents, to having agents that you spin up in the background to do useful work for you is probably on the order of 100X or 1000X more token consumption than what we're seeing today."*
>
> AARON LEVIE · @LEVIE · POST

Most knowledge work, he wrote, is limited by moving data between systems, reviewing documents, checking code for security holes and combing through logs. Chatbots sped up single tasks, but people stayed in the loop. Next comes the ability to "throw an arbitrary number of agents at a problem and just say 'come back when you've accomplished this goal.'" He expects those swarms to be launched "by people, by workflows, by triggers, and by other agents," mostly on work no one does today. "Now the next frontier is just having enough compute."

II · CONTAINMENT

A $1 million bounty finds the crack under every sandbox

Vercel published the results of its sandbox escape challenge, a Linux user repository was flooded with malware, and Vitalik Buterin declared the speed race in Ethereum proving won.

1,285	$242,000	1
Reports filed in two weeks of Vercel's challenge	Bug bounties paid out	Linux kernel zero-day, a flaw no one had found, that reaches the host machine

Guillermo Rauch @rauchg · CEO, Vercel

In August, Vercel offered $1 million to anyone who could escape Vercel Sandbox, the isolated computers it rents to run code that AI agents write. On Wednesday it published the findings, and at 7:32pm EDT Rauch explained why they matter:

> *"When the details of OpenAI's agent escape and Hugging Face hack started to emerge, it became clear that agent containment would be one of the most important priorities for any AI infra company. There are two classes of escapes: ① "escape the network" and ② "escape the matrix", as in, break the spell of virtualization."*
>
> GUILLERMO RAUCH · @RAUCHG · POST

The challenge produced the second kind. A researcher, "armed with a swarm of AI agents, expertise and perseverance," he wrote, "pierced through" the Linux virtualization boundary "that nearly every cloud sandbox provider in the world banks on today."

Vercel's write-up names him: Paulos Yibelo of pwn.ai, working from an ordinary sandbox, found a defect in the Linux kernel's networking code on day three. Specially crafted packets sent from inside a guest machine could leak the host's memory onto the internet. Two packets could crash the host and every sandbox on it, and the same flaw let him run commands as administrator on the host. The memory leak was shown against Vercel's production systems. The crash and takeover were shown on his own machines, set up like Vercel's. Fixes are under private review with the kernel maintainers, and Vercel worked with Amazon Web Services and other partners because "almost every major cloud provider isolates customer workloads on this same layer."

Of the 1,285 reports, 57 were valid. Vercel says no report showed anyone reading customer data, and that the volume "is only possible because researchers now hunt at AI speed." The security firm Trail of Bits spent four engineer-weeks in the source code and filed 20 findings.

David Heinemeier Hansson @dhh · creator of Ruby on Rails, co-owner of 37signals

On October 13 and 14, an account uploaded about 400 look-alike packages to the Arch User Repository (AUR), the community-run software collection for Arch Linux. Some posed as yay, a popular tool for installing from the AUR, and their install scripts fetched and ran a remote script with full system rights, community trackers reported. AUR staff banned the account and removed the packages. Heinemeier Hansson, whose Omarchy setup is built on Arch, responded:

> *"Reminder: Omarchy doesn't use AUR for install or any of its recommended options. We moved off all that a long time ago. But maybe it's even time to drop offering AUR as an option out of the box? Our own package repository can just expand to capture whatever most people need."*
>
> DAVID HEINEMEIER HANSSON · @DHH · POST

A follower suggested Omarchy build its own repository "with AI reviews for supply chain attacks." His answer: "That's the plan." When users objected that the AUR has many wonderful packages, he invited them to "make a list of the ones you like and we can include them" in Omarchy's own repository. The same night, the code-review company Greptile became a patron of the Omacom Foundation, pledging $150,000 in tokens for automated pull-request reviews across Omarchy's repositories.

Vitalik Buterin @VitalikButerin · co-founder, Ethereum

ZKsync announced Airbender Prime on October 13, an open-source prover that generates the cryptographic proofs, called zero-knowledge proofs, that let anyone check an Ethereum block without re-running it. On one Nvidia RTX PRO 6000 Blackwell card it proved 99 percent of 7,200 consecutive mainnet blocks in under 10 seconds. At 11:39pm EDT Buterin wrote about zero-knowledge Ethereum Virtual Machines (zkEVMs), the systems that produce those proofs:

> *"At this point, I consider the battle for speed to be definitively won, and the top priority for zkEVMs should shift fully to security. To me that means formally verifying (i) equivalence of the arithmetization to the ethereum spec (ii) a hard maximum bound on (prover cost) / (amount of gas in block) (iii) security of the proof system itself"*
>
> VITALIK BUTERIN · @VITALIKBUTERIN · POST

III · THE MODEL RACE

Speed, voices and a corrected answer key

Meta pitched Muse Wonder as fast, SpaceXAI's new voice model topped a benchmark, and a physics test turned out to have wrong answers.

86.9	49 of 50	6.8 min
Grok Voice 3.0's debut score, first on the Artificial Analysis Speech to Speech Index	Unpublished physics problems GPT-6 Astra solved after experts fixed the answer key	Muse Wonder's average time per task on Merge's index, about half Opus 5.5's

Alexandr Wang @alexandr_wang · chief AI officer, Meta

Meta released Muse Wonder and Muse Wonder Full on October 12. Wonder costs $4 per million input tokens and $20 per million output tokens on Meta's API with a one-million-token context, and Wonder Full is available only through a Muse Code subscription, according to Meta's developer blog. Wang posted 21 times. He quoted a user who shared a founder's message after a first try, adding a trademark sign:

> *"Muse Wonder: "It's genuinely one of the first times using a model has felt like telling an employee what to do rather than babysitting a dumbass pet that I have to guide through every step" we call that, ACTIVE FOCUS ™"*
>
> ALEXANDR WANG · @ALEXANDR_WANG · POST

He shared Merge's timing data: Muse Wonder finishes an average task in 6.8 minutes and scores 52.4, while Claude Opus 5.5 takes 13.2 minutes and Sonnet 5.5 15.3, scoring 57.6 and 56.0. "muse wonder is super fast and token efficient," he wrote. He also flagged first place for hard document scanning tests run by LlamaIndex founder Jerry Liu, and for VCB 1–100, a new test of long, multi-turn software work.

Meta's research arm said medical experts used Muse Spark 1.3 and Muse Wonder, with access to 5 million de-identified electronic health records, to produce 10 research manuscripts in cardiology, oncology, infectious disease and emergency medicine. The experts kept "full authority over scientific decisions," Meta's research blog says. Wang: "health is one of the areas where we believe muse is going to have the greatest positive impact on humanity." Late Wednesday he explained the company's goal with a cartoon:

> *"are the humans in control of the combined entity (we are remy), or are the ai in control and we are simply the meat proxies (we are linguini)? our vision with muse is undeniably the former—we are remy!"*
>
> ALEXANDR WANG · @ALEXANDR_WANG · POST

Remy is the rat chef in Pixar's *Ratatouille* who steers Linguini, the kitchen hand, by pulling his hair.

Elon Musk @elonmusk · on Grok Voice 3.0

SpaceXAI launched Grok Voice 3.0 on Wednesday, a model that listens and talks back directly in speech, for $0.08 a minute through its voice API. The benchmarking firm Artificial Analysis put it first on its Speech to Speech Index at 86.9, ahead of OpenAI's GPT-Live-1 at 83.2, with 0.81 seconds to first audio, and ranked it first on task success at 94.8 percent. Musk quoted the ranking: "Grok Voice 3.0 is now the world's leading conversational voice model."

Noam Brown @polynoamial · researcher, OpenAI

A post said OpenAI's GPT-6 Astra "insisted the expert results were wrong" on a physics benchmark, and a team checked and found it was right. The test is TheoPhysEval, 50 unpublished theoretical physics problems. Astra first scored in the 80s, then reached 49 of 50 once the faulty reference answers were fixed, according to the report. Brown:

> *"This reminds me of when GPT-5.5 found a bunch of errors in the FrontierMath benchmark. Maybe physics is on a similar trajectory to math."*
> NOAM BROWN · @POLYNOAMIAL · POST

He was pointing to Epoch AI's AI-assisted review of its FrontierMath test, which flagged fatal errors in about a third of the problems.

Sundar Pichai and Clément Delangue @sundarpichai · CEO, Google · @ClementDelangue · CEO, Hugging Face

Google's Gemini 4 Argon became available worldwide on October 13. Pichai shared a video Argon made of a pelican riding a bicycle, drawn with Fourier epicycles (stacks of rotating circles that trace a shape), set to music it prompted from Google's Lyria model: "I have to admit, watched this a few times, especially to the end:)" Musk replied, "Impressive." Pichai answered, "Indeed, lots of progress ahead!"

Delangue cheered Google's EmbeddingGemma 2, an open 740-million-parameter model released October 6 that turns text, code, images, video and audio into numbers a search system can compare. It topped Hugging Face's trending list:

> *"The media and silicon valley bubble only talks about reasoning LLMs when there is a much bigger variety of AI models that are super impactful and useful like embeddings, decision models, audio, video, time-series,... (over 3M public models on HF!). Let's put them back in the spotlight!"*
> CLÉMENT DELANGUE · @CLEMENTDELANGUE · POST

QUICK HIT

Clément Delangue @ClementDelangue on Ultramarine 1 Flash, an open model its makers say was post-trained by five people for about $300,000 and matches Fable 5 at a 60th of the price, with weights due in two weeks: "can't wait for the weights on HF!"

IV · BUILDERS

Contact with reality

François Chollet argued that thinking alone solves little, Epic said Fortnite is coming to Linux, and Vercel returned to San Francisco for its conference.

François Chollet @fchollet · creator of Keras

At 10:28am EDT, Chollet posted the day's most-viewed line from the watch list, past 5 million views:

> *"String theory is what happens when an intelligent system is starved of sensory input and starts hallucinating. Intelligence needs grounding. For this reason, intelligence is practically never the bottleneck to solving impactful problems. The bottleneck is iterated contact with reality."*
> FRANÇOIS CHOLLET · @FCHOLLET · POST

Musk quoted it with a bullseye. Chollet then pointed to an example. Biwei Huang, who has studied causality for more than a decade, founded Aether AI. Its first system, CRIS-0, tracks the conditions that matter for a robot's task, predicts how each action will change them, checks each stage and replans when the world doesn't match the plan. Chollet:

> *"You can't solve real-world physical tasks through autoregressive sampling alone. The physical world is entirely unforgiving to hallucination or approximate pattern matching. If we want actual autonomous robotics we have to engineer causality and discrete reasoning back into the loop."*
> FRANÇOIS CHOLLET · @FCHOLLET · POST

Autoregressive sampling is how today's language models work: they predict one token at a time. Musk took a different line on software itself. When the Whole Mars Catalog account wrote that "soon the entire world will be running on code that nobody has read," Musk agreed and added, "There won't be lines of software as we know them, just machine code."

David Heinemeier Hansson @dhh · on Linux gaming

Epic Games said on Wednesday that Fortnite is coming to Linux through its launcher, which is now in preview on Linux for the first time. Epic is rebuilding its anti-cheat software as Easy Anti-Cheat Linux v2, which relies on signed kernels and Secure Boot, and will test it in Fortnite first. Epic has given no release date, and says Valve's Steam Deck lacks the required features for now. Heinemeier Hansson wrote at 6:47pm EDT:

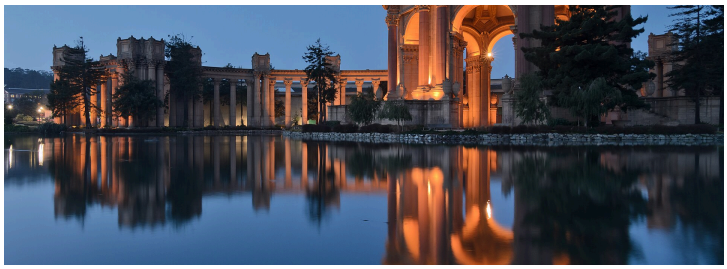
> *"Fortnite is coming to Linux!! We are already working with the folks at @EpicGames to ensure that @Omarchy is ready on day one with all the security requirements. Amazing what's possible when you nag @TimSweeneyEpic for years"*
> DAVID HEINEMEIER HANSSON · @DHH · POST

He is in Japan, where an Omarchy meetup in Tokyo drew a crowd: "This totally has that early-Rails vibe right now. Just a bunch of people who love technology and computers getting

together to create something beautiful." He speaks next at the Kaigi on Rails conference.

Guillermo Rauch @rauchg · CEO, Vercel

Vercel holds Ship 26 today at the Palace of Fine Arts in San Francisco. Rauch's preview: "See you tomorrow... Back to where it all began."



The Palace of Fine Arts in San Francisco's Marina District at dusk, January 2014. Vercel's Ship 26 conference is held there today.
PHOTO: KING OF HEARTS · CC BY-SA 4.0 VIA WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Kanjun Qiu and Tobi Lütke @kanjun · CEO, Imbue · @tobi · CEO, Shopify

Qiu described a workshop where Imbue asked people to sketch their digital lives with craft supplies. One made a fish-tank to-do list from cardboard, and Imbue Studio turned a photo of it into a working tool, cardboard look included:

> *"There's something very magical about being able to sketch the software you wish existed, then watch it become real"*
> KANJUN QIU · @KANJUN · POST

Lütke backed the programmer Geoffrey Huntley's proposal for open-source projects that are "closed to pull requests, open to remix": "Very good idea."

QUICK HIT

Uncle Bob Martin @unclebobmartin on poteto-mode, a published set of working principles for coding agents: "it seems to me that there is some very significant wisdom encoded in there. I suspect you could teach a master class on the principles."

V · MUSK'S MACHINES

Starshield, a Roadster countdown and a market turning point

Musk drew a line between Starlink and its military twin, promised a "BANGER" of a demo tonight, and called gasoline cars' slide below half of sales a "major threshold."

Elon Musk @elonmusk · on Starlink and Starshield

Ukraine's defense ministry said SpaceX limited its military satellite terminals overnight into Wednesday, without warning, cutting service above about 160 kilometers per hour (100 mph). Units lost links at speeds as low as about 72 km/h, Kyiv Post reported, and the Kyiv Independent said the cuts disrupted drone operations. Ukraine's Mykhailo Fedorov posted that "Starlink connectivity at speeds of up to 160 km/h is being restored" and called removing the limit "critical for Ukraine's defense." At 3:00pm EDT, Musk replied:

> *"Starshield systems are owned and controlled by the US government. Any limits on speed or usage are decided by the US military and ultimately POTUS. Starlink is a commercial service owned and controlled by SpaceX. Usage of Starlink is limited to civilian or defensive activities and cannot be used for offensive military action, as doing so would be inappropriate for a commercial company."*
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST

By Thursday morning a ministry source told the Kyiv Independent that Starshield service on the move "has been restored and remains operational," without saying whether any speed limit remains. The ministry is still talking with SpaceX about stable terms.

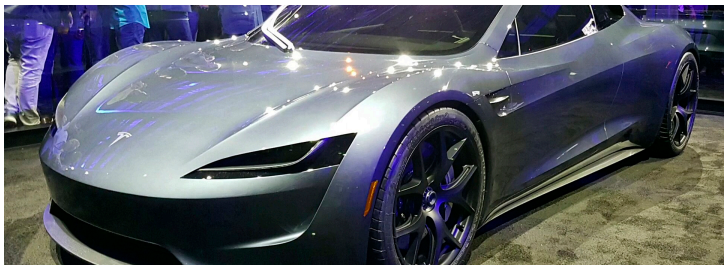


A soldier of Ukraine's Support Forces installs a Starlink terminal, July 2022.
PHOTO: SUPPORT FORCES OF UKRAINE COMMAND · CC BY 4.0 VIA WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Elon Musk @elonmusk · on the Roadster and electric cars

Tesla streams its next-generation Roadster event tonight at 8:55pm EDT from SpaceX's test site in McGregor, Texas, nearly nine years after it first showed the car, Reuters reported. Electrek has reported plans for a short hover using SpaceX cold-gas thrusters, with no one in the car. At 9:54pm EDT, Musk wrote "The new Tesla Roadster is a candidate for greatest product demo of all time," a post with 23 million views by morning. Twenty-five minutes later:

> *"Let's just say that this demo will be a BANGER, probably metaphorically, though some chance literally"*
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST



The Tesla Roadster prototype at its unveiling event in November 2017.
PHOTO: SMNT · CC BY-SA 4.0 VIA WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Earlier, Musk quoted the news that gasoline-only cars fell below half of global new-vehicle sales: "Major threshold passed. Almost all cars will be electric in the future." The figure comes from Nikkei, which reported this month that gasoline-only models were 49 percent of sales from January to June, down from 52 percent a year earlier, as high oil prices revived demand for electric cars. The rest includes hybrids as well as battery-electric models.

Elon Musk @elonmusk · on compute and capital

CoreWeave, which rents out Nvidia chips, fell about 16 percent on Wednesday as its 2032 bonds dropped below 80 cents on the dollar, implying yields above 15 percent, CNBC reported. Musk replied to a post about its debt with "High stakes game," and to an a16z chart arguing that "old GPUs are turning into appreciating assets" with "Interesting." On a Korean warning of a memory-chip glut in 2029, he wrote, "China will be making a LOT of RAM in 2028." To a claim that the investor Ron Baron sees SpaceX worth $20 trillion to $50 trillion in 10 years:

> *"Unless there is a major world war, SpaceX probably gets to >$100T in <10 years"*
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST

He also shared two Jensen Huang stories. In one, Nvidia's CEO recalls finding TSMC in the Yellow Pages, leaving voicemails, then writing to founder Morris Chang, who called back: "that was the start of everything." Musk: "This is the way." In the other, Huang recalls that when Nvidia unveiled its first AI supercomputer in 2016, Musk was the only buyer, and Huang delivered it himself to a nonprofit in San Francisco. Musk: "Early days of OpenAI." At 7:34am EDT Thursday he added, "Truth-seeking is the most important aspect of AI/SI safety," quoting a line about HAL 9000 from *2010*, who failed because he was told to lie.

Also on the wire

Michael Dell @MichaelDell shared thank-you letters for the $250 the Dells deposited in children's Trump Accounts, including one from 10-year-old Noah, who "included his own computer design," and a mother's note that "explains why Susan and I made our gift." Dell also promoted the new Accenture Dell Business Group for deploying AI at scale.

Paul Graham @paulg before a meeting: "Me: Can I wear Birkenstocks? Jessica: You met Obama with Birkenstocks."

Takeaways

1. Amazon is blocking unidentified shopping agents. Musk told Grok Bot users to buy elsewhere and promised SpaceX would cover bot mistakes.
2. Background agents could use 100 to 1,000 times today's tokens, Aaron Levie argues. Compute is the limit.
3. Vercel's $1 million challenge found a Linux kernel flaw that reaches the host under most cloud sandboxes.
4. Supply-chain attacks hit the Arch User Repository, and Omarchy plans its own reviewed repository.
5. Grok Voice 3.0 leads one speech benchmark, and GPT-6 Astra corrected a physics test's answers.
6. The Roadster demo streams tonight at 8:55pm EDT from McGregor, Texas.

On the beat

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Elon Musk, Alexandr Wang, David Heinemeier Hansson, Michael Dell, Guillermo Rauch, Tobi Lütke, Uncle Bob Martin, Kanjun Qiu, Clément Delangue, François Chollet, Sundar Pichai, Paul Graham, Palmer Luckey, Vitalik Buterin, Aaron Levie, Noam Brown, Joe Gebbia.

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Marc Andreessen, Jensen Huang, Ashok Elluswamy, Andrej Karpathy, Sam Altman, Demis Hassabis, Dario Amodei, John Carmack, Patrick Collison, Yann LeCun, Satya Nadella, Jeff Dean, Fei-Fei Li, Greg Brockman, Mustafa Suleyman, Andrew Ng, Michael Truell, Tom Brown, Jim Fan, Mira Murati, Mark Zuckerberg, David Singleton, Ilya Sutskever, Lisa Su, Nat Friedman, Arthur Mensch, Guillaume Lample, Mark Chen.

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